

MIGRATION THEORIES AND PATTERNS (INDIA)

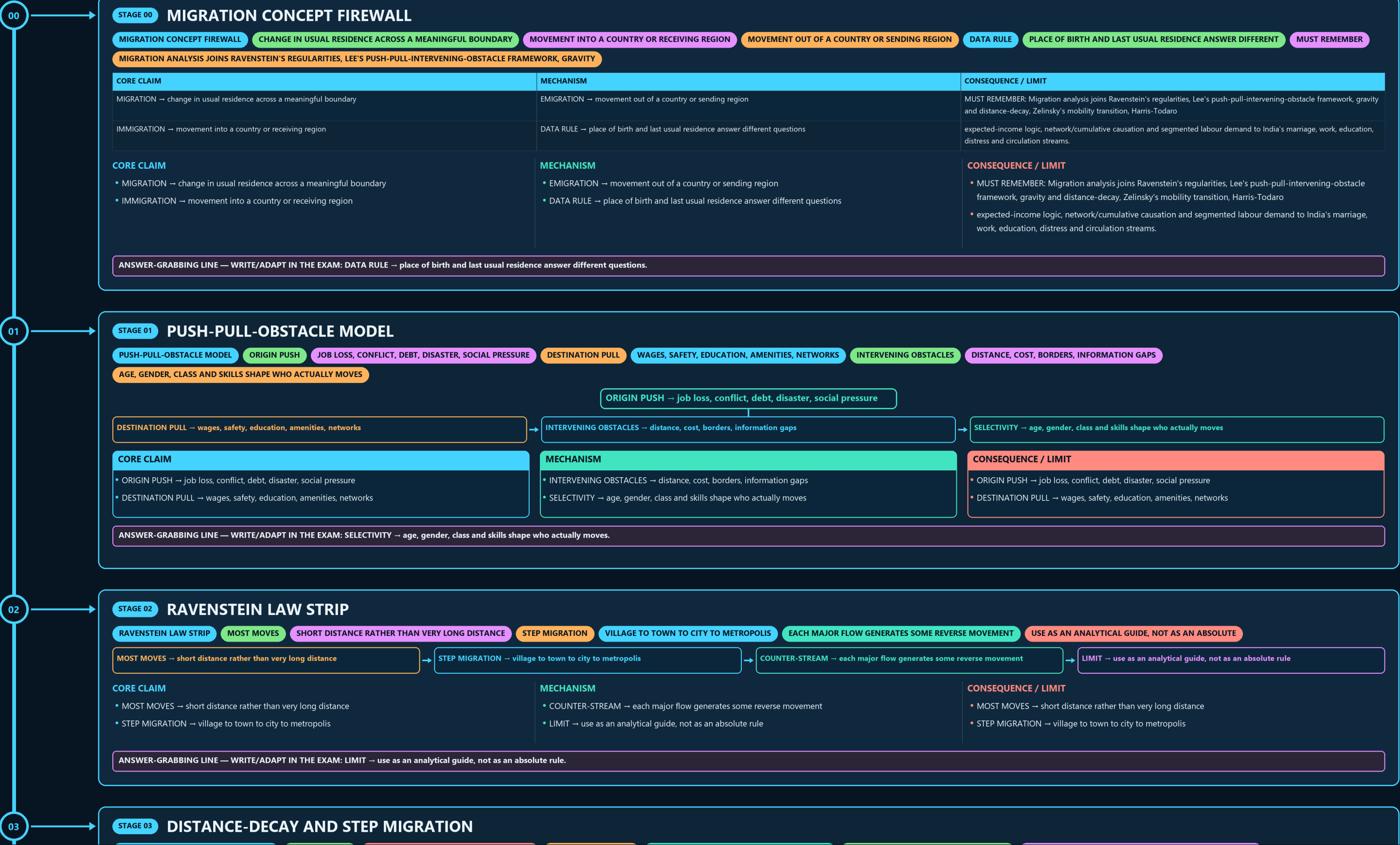
MIGRATION CONCEPT FIREWALL → PUSH-PULL-OBSTACLE MODEL → RAVENSTEIN LAW STRIP → DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION → MIGRATION STREAM MATRIX → SOURCE-DESTINATION BALANCE SHEET

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g6 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

CORE CLAIM

- MOST MOVES → short distance rather than very long distance
- STEP MIGRATION → village to town to city to metropolis

MECHANISM

- COUNTER-STREAM → each major flow generates some reverse movement
- LIMIT → use as an analytical guide, not as an absolute rule

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MOST MOVES → short distance rather than very long distance
- STEP MIGRATION → village to town to city to metropolis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → use as an analytical guide, not as an absolute rule.

03

STAGE 03

DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION

DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION

DISTANCE RISES

COST, UNCERTAINTY AND SOCIAL RISK RISE

OPPORTUNITY NODES

NEARER TOWNS INTERCEPT PART OF THE FLOW

REDUCE COST AND KEEP CORRIDORS ALIVE

MANY MIGRANTS MOVE IN STAGES RATHER THAN ONE LEAP

DISTANCE RISES → cost, uncertainty and social risk rise

→

OPPORTUNITY NODES → nearer towns intercept part of the flow

→

NETWORKS → reduce cost and keep corridors alive

→

RESULT → many migrants move in stages rather than one leap

CORE CLAIM

- DISTANCE RISES → cost, uncertainty and social risk rise
- OPPORTUNITY NODES → nearer towns intercept part of the flow

MECHANISM

- NETWORKS → reduce cost and keep corridors alive
- RESULT → many migrants move in stages rather than one leap

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DISTANCE RISES → cost, uncertainty and social risk rise
- OPPORTUNITY NODES → nearer towns intercept part of the flow

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → many migrants move in stages rather than one leap.

04

STAGE 04

MIGRATION STREAM MATRIX

MIGRATION STREAM MATRIX

MARRIAGE, LOCAL FARM LABOUR, NEARBY RELOCATION

LABOUR, SERVICES, EDUCATION, CONSTRUCTION

PROFESSIONAL, BUSINESS AND HIGHER-EDUCATION MOBILITY

RETURN MIGRATION, RETIREMENT OR PERI-URBAN SPILLOVER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation	URBAN-URBAN → professional, business and higher-education mobility	RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation
RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction	URBAN-RURAL → return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover	RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction

CORE CLAIM

- RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation
- RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction

MECHANISM

- URBAN-URBAN → professional, business and higher-education mobility
- URBAN-RURAL → return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation
- RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: URBAN-RURAL → return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover.

05

STAGE 05

SOURCE-DESTINATION BALANCE SHEET

SOURCE-DESTINATION BALANCE SHEET

REDUCED PRESSURE, REMITTANCES, BUT LOSS OF YOUNG WORKERS

LABOUR GAIN, MARKET EXPANSION, BUT SERVICE PRESSURE

AGE-SEX EFFECT

SELECTIVE MIGRATION ALTERS BOTH ENDS DIFFERENTLY

MIGRATION REDISTRIBUTES BOTH OPPORTUNITY AND VULNERABILITY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers	AGE-SEX EFFECT → selective migration alters both ends differently	SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers
DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure	VERDICT → migration redistributes both opportunity and vulnerability	DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure

CORE CLAIM

- SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers
- DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure

MECHANISM

- AGE-SEX EFFECT → selective migration alters both ends differently
- VERDICT → migration redistributes both opportunity and vulnerability

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers
- DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → migration redistributes both opportunity and vulnerability.

06

STAGE 06

INDIA OFFICIAL SNAPSHOT

INDIA OFFICIAL SNAPSHOT

ALL-INDIA RATE

28.9% IN MOSPI MIGRATION IN INDIA 2020-21

RURAL RATE

URBAN RATE

LABEL THE SOURCE-YEAR BEFORE USING ANY PERCENTAGE

RURAL RATE → 26.5%	URBAN RATE → 34.9%
INTRASTATE → 87.5%	INTERSTATE → 12.5%

CORE CLAIM

- ALL-INDIA RATE → 28.9% in MoSPI Migration in India 2020-21
- RURAL RATE → 26.5%

MECHANISM

- URBAN RATE → 34.9%
- INTRASTATE → 87.5%

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- INTERSTATE → 12.5%
- RULE → label the source-year before using any percentage

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06

STAGE 06

INDIA OFFICIAL SNAPSHOT

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ALL-INDIA RATE

28.9% IN MOSPI MIGRATION IN INDIA 2020-21

RURAL RATE

URBAN RATE

LABEL THE SOURCE-YEAR BEFORE USING ANY PERCENTAGE

RURAL RATE → 26.5%

URBAN RATE → 34.9%

INTRASTATE → 87.5%

INTERSTATE → 12.5%

CORE CLAIM

- ALL-INDIA RATE → 28.9% in MoSPI Migration in India 2020-21
- RURAL RATE → 26.5%

MECHANISM

- URBAN RATE → 34.9%
- INTRASTATE → 87.5%

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- INTERSTATE → 12.5%
- RULE → label the source-year before using any percentage

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → label the source-year before using any percentage.

07

STAGE 07

MARRIAGE MIGRATION DOMINANCE

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FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE

86.8% IN MOSPI 2020-21

ANALYTICAL RESULT

RAW MIGRATION TOTALS ARE NOT EQUAL TO LABOUR MIGRATION

RURAL-RURAL STREAM

REMAINS LARGE BECAUSE MARRIAGE MOBILITY IS LARGE

EXAM USE

CORE CLAIM

FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21

ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration

MECHANISM

RURAL-RURAL STREAM → remains large because marriage mobility is large

EXAM USE → separate social migration from labour migration explicitly

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21

ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration

CORE CLAIM

- FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21
- ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration

MECHANISM

- RURAL-RURAL STREAM → remains large because marriage mobility is large
- EXAM USE → separate social migration from labour migration explicitly

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21
- ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration.

08

STAGE 08

INDIA CORRIDOR MAP

INDIA CORRIDOR MAP

SENDING BELTS

BIHAR, UTTAR PRADESH, ODISHA AND EAST-CENTRAL REGIONS

GAINER ZONES

MAHARASHTRA, GUJARAT, DELHI, HARYANA AND PUNJAB

CURRENT LOGIC

LABOUR MOVES TOWARD INDUSTRIAL, FARM AND SERVICE CORRIDORS

THE SAME CORRIDOR MAY MIX OPPORTUNITY AND DISTRESS MIGRATION

SENDING BELTS → Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central regions

GAINER ZONES → Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab

CURRENT LOGIC → labour moves toward industrial, farm and service corridors

QUALIFIER → the same corridor may mix opportunity and distress migration

CORE CLAIM

- SENDING BELTS → Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central regions
- GAINER ZONES → Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab

MECHANISM

- CURRENT LOGIC → labour moves toward industrial, farm and service corridors
- QUALIFIER → the same corridor may mix opportunity and distress migration

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SENDING BELTS → Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central regions
- GAINER ZONES → Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFIER → the same corridor may mix opportunity and distress migration.

09

STAGE 09

CIRCULAR MIGRATION AND UNDERCOUNT

CIRCULAR MIGRATION AND UNDERCOUNT

SEASONAL MOVEMENT

BRICK KILNS, HARVESTING, CONSTRUCTION, INFORMAL WORK

USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA

CAN MISS REPEATED SHORT-DURATION MOBILITY

POLICY EFFECT

PORTABILITY OF WELFARE BECOMES A MAJOR ISSUE

CITY EFFECT

SEASONAL MOVEMENT → brick kilns, harvesting, construction, informal work

USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA → can miss repeated short-duration mobility

POLICY EFFECT → portability of welfare becomes a major issue

CITY EFFECT → rental insecurity and service pressure stay concentrated

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Migrant stock differs from flow, lifetime from last-residence

CORE CLAIM

- SEASONAL MOVEMENT → brick kilns, harvesting, construction, informal work
- USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA → can miss repeated short-duration mobility
- POLICY EFFECT → portability of welfare becomes a major issue

MECHANISM

- CITY EFFECT → rental insecurity and service pressure stay concentrated
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Migrant stock differs from flow, lifetime from last-residence
- migration, internal from international movement, seasonal/circular from permanent relocation, and

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Census reason-for-migration categories from causal explanation
- women recorded under marriage can also be workers, so one response category must not erase economic agency.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Census reason-for-migration categories from causal explanation; women recorded under marriage can also be workers, so one response category must not erase economic agency.

informal work

mobility

concentrated

from last-residence

CORE CLAIM

- SEASONAL MOVEMENT → brick kilns, harvesting, construction, informal work
- USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA → can miss repeated short-duration mobility
- POLICY EFFECT → portability of welfare becomes a major issue

MECHANISM

- CITY EFFECT → rental insecurity and service pressure stay concentrated
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Migrant stock differs from flow, lifetime from last-residence
- migration, internal from international movement, seasonal/circular from permanent relocation, and

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Census reason-for-migration categories from causal explanation; women recorded under marriage can also be workers, so one response category must not erase economic agency.

10

STAGE 10

LARGE-CITY ATTRACTION LOGIC

LARGE-CITY ATTRACTION LOGIC

DIVERSE JOB SET

BIG CITIES OFFER MULTIPLE LABOUR-MARKET ENTRY POINTS

EARLIER MIGRANTS LOWER COST AND RISK FOR LATER MIGRANTS

TRANSPORT + SERVICES

LARGE NODES COMPRESS SEARCH COSTS

SOME NEARER TOWNS INTERCEPT FLOWS AS OPPORTUNITIES EXPAND

EVIDENCE LIMIT

DIVERSE JOB SET → big cities offer multiple labour-market entry points

NETWORKS → earlier migrants lower cost and risk for later migrants

TRANSPORT + SERVICES → large nodes compress search costs

COUNTERPOINT → some nearer towns intercept flows as opportunities expand

EVIDENCE LIMIT: India patterns require Bihar–Uttar Pradesh source belts

CORE CLAIM

- DIVERSE JOB SET → big cities offer multiple labour-market entry points
- NETWORKS → earlier migrants lower cost and risk for later migrants
- TRANSPORT + SERVICES → large nodes compress search costs

MECHANISM

- COUNTERPOINT → some nearer towns intercept flows as opportunities expand
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: India patterns require Bihar–Uttar Pradesh source belts,
- Delhi–NCR/Mumbai/Surat/Bengaluru destinations, Kerala–Gulf corridors, tribal and drought-prone seasonal streams, remittances and care/skill loss

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- Census 2011 is the latest completed census baseline as of the review date, while surveys and administrative records are partial.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Delhi–NCR/Mumbai/Surat/Bengaluru destinations, Kerala–Gulf corridors, tribal and drought-prone seasonal streams, remittances and care/skill loss; Census 2011 is the latest completed census baseline as of the review date, while surveys and administrative records are partial.

11

STAGE 11

MIGRATION ANSWER SPINE

MIGRATION ANSWER SPINE

RESIDENCE RULE, STREAM TYPE AND WHETHER MIGRATION IS INTERNAL

PUSH, PULL, OBSTACLES, DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION

MARRIAGE-HEAVY RURAL-RURAL AND LABOUR-HEAVY CORRIDOR MOVEMENTS IN INDIA

INTRASTATE DOMINANCE, REMITTANCES, UNDERCOUNT AND VERIFIED PYQ ROUTING

DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international

EXPLAIN → push, pull, obstacles, distance-decay and step migration

MAP → marriage-heavy rural-rural and labour-heavy corridor movements in India

QUALIFY → intrastate dominance, remittances, undercount and verified PYQ routing

CORE CLAIM

- DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international
- EXPLAIN → push, pull, obstacles, distance-decay and step migration

MECHANISM

- MAP → marriage-heavy rural-rural and labour-heavy corridor movements in India
- QUALIFY → intrastate dominance, remittances, undercount and verified PYQ routing

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international
- EXPLAIN → push, pull, obstacles, distance-decay and step migration

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

TODAY THE BROAD LOGIC STILL SURVIVES IN UPDATED FORM

CONSTRUCTION, SERVICE AND METROPOLITAN CORRIDORS ATTRACT LABOUR FROM LOWER-INCOME

DELHI NCR, THE MUMBAI-PUNE BELT, GUJARAT'S INDUSTRIAL CORRIDOR, PUNJAB-HARYANA

AND LOGISTICS ZONES, AND BENGALURU-LED SERVICE REGIONS REMAIN HIGH-ATTRACTION

MIGRATION IN INDIA IS THEREFORE BOTH DEVELOPMENT-SEEKING AND DISTRESS-DRIVEN

THE SAME CORRIDOR CAN CONTAIN BOTH ASPIRATION AND DISTRESS

ONE WORKER MAY MIGRATE FOR SKILL-LED MOBILITY, ANOTHER FOR

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- CAUTION: Today the broad logic still survives in updated form: industrial,
- construction, service and metropolitan corridors attract labour from lower-income agrarian regions.
- CAUTION: Delhi NCR, the Mumbai-Pune belt, Gujarat's industrial corridor, Punjab-Haryana farm
- and logistics zones, and Bengaluru-led service regions remain high-attraction spaces.

ADVANCED DEBATE

- CAUTION: Migration in India is therefore both development-seeking and distress-driven .
- CAUTION: The same corridor can contain both aspiration and distress: one worker may migrate for skill-led mobility, another for survival.
- CAUTION: Rural-urban migration is not automatically a sign of successful structural transformation if urban jobs remain informal and insecure.
- CAUTION: Pandemic-era reverse migration made seasonal and circular labour mobility far more visible in policy debate.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- MoSPI / NSS / PLFS-based report: latest official migration survey snapshot.
- Census of India: long-run migration concepts, place-of-birth and last-residence tables.
- CAUTION: For answer quality, always distinguish census concept, survey concept and temporary/circular movement.
- Most migrants in India are intrastate, not interstate.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.